DPH User Guide

Delphi Project Handoff

Windows desktop experimental software

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For the person inspecting a Delphi project and recording its handoff knowledge

This guide describes the implemented application and its evidence limits. Use the phase acceptance records for exact measured results and unresolved release gates.

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Purpose and evidence

Delphi Project Handoff explains an explicitly selected Delphi project through source inventory, form information, symbols, relationships, control flow and attributed knowledge. It stores its work in one SQLite knowledge database per selected project. DPH is experimental Windows desktop software. Its static analysis is not a Delphi compiler and does not prove every runtime behavior.

Use the generation number, source hashes, certainty labels and diagnostics together. A complete captured analysis means the implemented analysis stages accepted their captured inputs. It does not mean a human approved the business explanation. PARTIAL means unavailable dependencies, unsupported syntax or bounded analysis prevented full coverage. DPH does not compile or execute the selected project, run its build scripts, load its component classes or connect to its production services.

Start DPH

Start DelphiProjectHandoff.exe from its deployed folder. Keep the migrations folder and Microsoft WebView2 loader with the deployment. WebView2 Runtime supports the optional embedded HTML preview. An unavailable preview must leave the exported HTML usable independently. The initial validated target is Windows Win32; another operating system has not been validated.

The workspace has a left Explorer, central tabs and right Inspector. Drag either vertical splitter to resize the panes. The header contains project selection, cache opening, full reassessment, configuration, platform, extra defines and explicit dependency roots. The status area shows work in progress and the captured analysis status. The last successfully opened database identity is remembered in the local user profile and reopens detached.

Attach a source project

Choose Attach project and select the Delphi project file. The picker accepts dproj, dpr or groupproj. Choose a database filename ending in dphdb outside the analyzed source folder. DPH rejects database and export locations inside the source boundary and rejects reparse paths that could bypass that boundary. Keep each selected project in its own database.

Select Debug or Release and Win32 or Win64 as appropriate before analysis. Win64 is an analysis configuration choice; the current DPH executable is built for Win32. Extra defines use semicolons. Explicit dependency roots also use semicolons. Add only roots you intend to permit DPH to read. A missing dependency is a visible gap, not a reason to let discovery search neighboring projects without a boundary.

For the pinned VCL2FMXConverter Win32 reference, enter MSWINDOWS;WIN32 as extra defines to reproduce the recorded baseline. DPH does not synthesize every compiler built-in from the platform label. Supply the symbols required by the selected compiler environment; unknown conditional expressions remain uncertain.

Analysis runs in the background. Explorer data belongs to its displayed generation while the worker prepares another. Changed inputs during a scan supersede the capture and request reassessment. A partial or failed capture does not replace a previous complete published head. DPH retains the evidence needed to inspect partial results honestly.

Open cached work

Choose Open cache to inspect a saved dphdb database. DPH validates the cached workspace artifact against its SHA256 and generation before displaying it. Cached opening does not start a source scan. The cache opens detached until you explicitly attach its source project.

Detached mode allows historical inspection and authored notes. It does not follow cached filesystem paths to display source text or approve a current-source review. Attach the source when you want live hash checks, source navigation and human verification against current evidence. A missing or damaged cached artifact is reported rather than silently treated as a current view.

Keep a copied database with its adjacent database.dphdb.views folder. DPH resolves cache files beside the opened database and verifies their hashes instead of following old absolute artifact paths. To move the source project, choose Relocate verified source and select the same project entry. Exact file identities, content hashes, availability and analysis selection must match the captured generation. A different copy is rejected. Accepted relocation preserves logical symbols and notes, requests human review and reassesses the new context.

Explore and search

Double-click an Explorer row to select its canonical object. The Inspector shows its identity, signature, condition, source range, source hash and serialized properties when available. Units, types, components and routines provide drill-down scopes. The breadcrumb reports the active scope and page. Parent moves upward; Back restores a prior selection.

Search matches object names, kinds and signatures across the project. A kind filter narrows the result. Pages contain at most 250 objects; Next page advances the result set. Clear the search or use Parent to broaden your route. Bookmark records the current canonical selection, and Bookmarks displays those selections. Bookmarks belong to the captured generation and reset when a new generation is loaded.

The References tab lists forward and reverse relationships with their certainty and derivation labels. Double-click a resolvable related object to inspect it. An unresolved target remains unresolved; the relationship is not proof that a named method actually ran.

Read source and graph evidence

The Source tab reads the attached source file and compares its bytes with the captured SHA256 before applying the source range. If the live file changed or cannot be decoded, DPH displays a stale or unavailable message instead of presenting the old range as a confirmed live location. External dependencies remain in the evidence model but are not followed by the local source viewer through an invented path.

The Graphs tab offers Execution, Procedure CFG, Caller / callee, Form navigation, Data flow and Change impact. Select a relevant routine or component before choosing a narrow graph. Graphs show at most 120 nodes and 960 edges. A narrower selection is preferable to interpreting a truncated large view as the complete program.

Confirmed static edges use blue. Uncertain edges use orange dashes. A procedure control-flow graph shows the implemented static branches and source ranges. Form navigation is ownership, event and call evidence; it does not prove runtime window activation. Change impact is possible reachability through typed relationships, not proved runtime impact. Click a node to inspect its evidence.

Inspect screens

The Screens tab reconstructs rectangles and text from serialized FMX or DFM data. It never creates untrusted component classes. The result is explicitly an approximate design-time view, not an actual runtime screenshot. Custom painting, runtime geometry, styles and unavailable inherited resources may differ from the running program.

Thumbnail displays a gallery of up to 60 forms. Fit scales the selected form to the viewport, Native uses its reconstructed size, Zoom displays 200 percent, and Full screen uses the larger window. The Full screen button toggles the DPH window size. Click a component rectangle to navigate to the corresponding canonical object when a source association is available.

Write attributed knowledge

Use the Knowledge tab for notes, business rules, engineering rules, user help, maintenance, build and deployment details, troubleshooting, orientation, decisions and unknowns. Select the relevant Explorer object before starting New to link the record to that object. With no selected object, a new record applies to the project.

Enter a stable title, choose its kind, supply a named author and write the body. Save creates a new immutable revision pending human review. Titles and kinds remain stable after creation; update the body, or create and retire a replacement. Selecting a saved row displays its text, links, current state and complete authored and review history.

Unsaved text survives a background refresh. Save or explicitly Discard edit before switching projects, selecting another record, starting another record or closing. DPH will not silently approve an old saved revision while different unsaved text is visible.

Review and retire knowledge

Enter the named reviewer and select a saved revision. Verify review records your explicit approval of that text against the captured generation. Reject records a rejected explanation. Retire preserves an obsolete record and its history while resolving its pending task. The Pending reviews only filter shows records that still need attention.

Source or configuration changes invalidate human review separately from analysis. A successful rescan preserves authored text but cannot approve it. When a linked method disappears or is renamed, DPH keeps the old link as historical evidence and refuses to transfer verified knowledge automatically. Investigate continuity and create the appropriate reviewed replacement.

Attribution is a local named-author record, not an enterprise authentication system. A verified human explanation records the reviewer decision; it does not establish unwritten historical business intent automatically. Detached review requires source attachment first.

Publish manuals and handoffs

Open Publish. Choose Full project or Selected object and context. The task choice requires a selected canonical object and includes its incident technical context rather than a blind truncation of a full export. Enter explicit relative file or folder exclusions separated by semicolons. External source roots and sensitive filename categories are excluded by default.

Choose a new export folder name outside the source tree. DPH refuses an existing destination to avoid overwriting unrelated files. It creates offline index.html, local assets, canonical.json, editable engineering and user guides, technical JSONL indexes, evidence references, coverage and a checksum manifest. Generated AGENTS.md and source snapshots are excluded unless a separate explicit request is implemented and authorized.

Preview offline HTML opens only the approved local index through Edge. External addresses and arbitrary file navigation are blocked. Offline search and internal links work without a translation service. Atlas is unconfigured. The GTranslate region is disabled in the offline edition, and the language-label helper is local. No external translation or AI service receives source through this feature.

Run tools/export-pdf.ps1 with the BundleDirectory parameter for optional PDF companions. It uses LibreOffice and the approved Python 3.13 with pypdf, populates cached TOC page numbers while retaining changeable fields, and refreshes bundle checksums. Read coverage and known unknowns before treating an export as a final operating manual. Automatic documentation cannot invent missing end-user procedures.

Validate and preserve exports

Run DPH.ValidateHandoff.exe with the bundle directory and a separately retained trusted input fingerprint. It rejects stale exports by default. Add --allow-stale only to inspect the integrity of a historical or partial bundle; the flag does not establish current or complete source evidence.

Validate artifact filenames and SHA256 values against validation/manifest-sha256.json. The manifest records generation, input fingerprint, template version, scope, stale state and canonical hash. The validator also checks symbol, relationship, control-flow and evidence references and source ranges. A changed expected fingerprint rejects a stale bundle.

Hashes detect changed artifacts relative to their checksum index. They are not a digital signature proving the identity of an untrusted bundle author. Keep a trusted copy of the source fingerprint and export identity. Redaction recognizes common credential assignments, access keys, tokens and private keys; explicit exclusions and a disclosure review remain necessary for sensitive projects.

Keep the dphdb database together with its managed dphdb.views folder. The database is the authority for authored knowledge; generated manuals and diagrams are derived outputs. Project development backups are made before each authorized phase to D:, and validated changes are committed and pushed to both configured GitHub repositories.

Troubleshoot common states

PARTIAL analysis: read diagnostics and source availability. Unavailable framework units and unsupported syntax remain visible gaps. Do not clear the label by treating unresolved facts as verified. Source changed during analysis: allow reassessment or invoke Full reassessment after the source settles.

Cached artifact missing or damaged: retain the database and its previous backups, then attach the correct source to rebuild a derived workspace. Different source root: DPH rejects cross-project reuse; relocation must preserve and verify project identity rather than attach an unrelated project. Knowledge changed since loading: refresh and review the current immutable revision before saving.

Embedded preview unavailable: inspect index.html in the exported folder and check the deployed Microsoft loader and WebView2 Runtime. No named author or reviewer: enter an attributable name. Closing waits for

background work: cancellation is checked at safe stage boundaries; a long parser stage does not execute the analyzed program.

Practice a maintenance handoff

Locate startup from the selected project inventory. Find the main form and a visible action, follow its serialized event to the handler, inspect callbacks and downstream calls, and distinguish certain edges from inferred ones. Locate a dry-run branch or another configuration-dependent path, then identify the model used to produce a report.

Record what the evidence establishes and what remains unknown. Add an attributed author answer for missing business rationale, reassess a controlled source change, and verify that the explanation remains pending review. Export a focused task bundle and validate its hashes. This scripted practice supports onboarding; it does not replace the required independent first-time programmer acceptance exercise.

Source and revision evidence

The following source files and resources define this guide. SHA256 values identify the inspected implementation. Rebuild the guides after validated changes and retain the associated acceptance evidence.

DPH.Analysis.Flow.pas

`7ae133ca49ea4461c3cfa5a2f659bb035acfa463d34668eac091f405eee0fbad`

DPH.Analysis.Model.pas

`63797e406476e2e527b8fd28b75bbccedbe0820657217457e0329252792bd417`

DPH.Analysis.Persistence.pas

`5771a6e098cd57a17d6221474e0864785675b7240875ccc4e4f9ff284a92a6e6`

DPH.Analysis.Symbols.pas

`3af351398e978e521920fbbd33b8da9d35c1d129176b11437ef836231d0b9a31`

DPH.Parse.Forms.pas

`8b0a82186f7831bd1c27bf377409ac6e49b77c228666e6087fca8758c85d4cc7`

DPH.Parse.Lexer.pas

`6ce5bbc66f8170b17eaeda536b8e500ca9992131477c09bc8e1a33bb6dd1c7f0`

DPH.Parse.Model.pas

`5eb5afb595a879cde199cd029349890990cc58cefdea20e643447dca7bca4f4e`

DPH.Parse.Pascal.pas

`e89e29fce1ece85d5a0ecafad0cf397f42d4797e9f12c997a6ffafe19e0db0c8`

DPH.Parse.Preprocessor.pas

`34b7513019a41bc9911babfda72041addd563959ee54c54d0759b8cc9fa7fefc`

DPH.Project.Analysis.pas

`cad87d7a998ace018b3e57e430ce4737e2679adc378091782aefd07685c803a5`

DPH.Project.Inventory.pas

b430015f92c1860234c0b6e75f3c0df67bd8f59803d7030be500260bd913f1fa

DPH.Project.Source.pas

c2e1ff86fc0ee3435be23cb6fd07bd9df6d43c6954def70cca23f2edf62162cd

DPH.Publish.BrowserPolicy.pas

ba8df0c1f86f6ecddfa605438764e8dbe5a1dcc858e5a625c677c59a63f77bef

DPH.Publish.Export.pas

4a725ef7f3f055e8092bb666d0b5bea6efa40e18f9d052595eb99583d963e122

DPH.Publish.Model.pas

c3aa365fdc3fc34e5178a8676aeb2d113a4121f57966d7c734ab3375692d7d5e

DPH.Publish.Translation.pas

d211794576a0e234d1aa8ac347d09f6a981e9590346204ef142608aa5aa400b2

DPH.Storage.Database.pas

f7eef8833ab8547d7308307f2b98120fa165865bb3143cf0d4fcad2c711acc4d

DPH.Storage.Types.pas

1e83ccbe6868979ff9d763a4f2bf4d64691c2b2343de6717391f03e204d5d219

DPH.UI.Main.pas

36943dcb465a3e3a1a87ecb34053ceb5be8710c59cdd9bac1ba5af267cadb806

DPH.Workspace.Model.pas

99b456e51f003453beb53892d419af0bd98b747a08062391e0a709ca803d78c7

DPH.Workspace.Screen.pas

68305e6ec36664e76d05b8c9af21416dd51a32116d47ea55156977b4c10855de

DPH.Workspace.Worker.pas

8e9e7fcca3f0d7dc6d13c4cbd3538b8c89e5754f8561b176ca244258419bd6c6

DPH.UI.Main.fmx

26672ce9b236a79b3ed89a9b8ac534718f06f711d556c34929e271b9bf894f67

DelphiProjectHandoff.dpr

3a7069ba071bb567f4d61da03cca38db4a12b1c700bca885c7e2a46a52d71732

DelphiProjectHandoff.dproj

23428c608a2cee9b8e1bb343af3e201abbe3579e3e49bac25a3b773744701839